THE INDIAN APPROACH: NORTH OVER SOUTH

Almost the same theme was provided by a renowned Indian scholar of international relations, Prof. Jayantanuja Bandyopadhyaya in his famous work *North Over South—A Non-Western Perspective of International Relations* (1984). He highlighted that the structure of the contemporary international system is the legacy of four-and-a-half centuries of European imperialism. This has resulted in a structural division of the international system into two subsystems. One small but dominant, and the other large but subordinate. The dominant subsystem is located in the geographical North and the subordinate subsystem in the geographical South of the globe.[26]

Whereas the dominant subsystem in the North experienced the industrial revolution centuries ago and has also gone through the phase of Second Industrial Revolution or the Technotronic or Cybernetic Revolution, the subordinate subsystem of the South has failed to even experience their first industrial revolution. This is mostly because of their impoverishment by historical imperialism and contemporary neo-imperialism, which again has caused the affluence of the North at the cost of the drain of wealth from the South. The situation has not changed even after the process of decolonization and the so-called “transfer of power”. The imperialist gain continues through more sophisticated and finer mechanisms. Poverty, hunger and underdevelopment still haunt the developing countries as developed countries continue to enrich themselves. Therefore, the North–South contradiction is the central or primary contradiction within the international system.

Criticisms

Professor Jayantanuja Bandyopadhyaya has shown that the World System Theory has given us deep insights into the working of international system which tends to be oligarchic and hegemonistic. He says, however, that this reductionist determinism of the theory detracts from its ability to explain the impact of domestic structures on the foreign policies of state in detail or in a methodologically and logically acceptable manner. There is no reference to the role of any structural elements other than class in the analysis. Political parties,